



support them with twigs or short canes, and earth them up to give stability. Guide climbers up their supports and pinch out growing tips when they reach the top.

HARVESTING

Harvest once pods are large enough for use and eat while they are still young and tender. The more pods you pick, the more are produced, so check plants every few days for new growth. If beans are grown for drying, leave them on the plant until they dry out and the seed pods rattle. Green beans can also be frozen for later use.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Protect seedlings against slugs and snails, and be wary of bean beetles and black bean aphids, which will target leaves and young pods. Discourage diseases such as halo blight and fusarium rot by practicing crop rotation.



Bean seed maggots attack germinating seeds—protect by sowing under cover.